



PACIFIC
OCEAN

LANAI

KAHOLAUI

MAUI

HAWAII

Diary entry

As I opened the lid of the travel trunk, a hideous smell seeped out of its darkness.

Little bottles filled with insects preserved in amber fluid clattered together as I lifted the remains of an old butterfly net and strange ladies' clothes from the top.

Underneath were maps and bundles of letters and postcards from all around the world. A few dated as far back as 1893.

Neatly tucked in a leather pouch attached to the lid I found a journal belonging to a Miss Lillian Wild. Beside it was a small bone-handled pocket knife engraved with her initials. I made myself comfortable, opened the journal and began to read ...

- On which island is Kilauea volcano?
(A) Maui (B) Oahu (C) Kauai (D) Hawaii
- When Lillian Wild wrote 'I ... lost my horse', she meant that
(A) she fell off the horse.
(B) she could not find the horse.
(C) the horse was unable to continue.
(D) the horse was given to another rider.
- Which part of the volcano is the summit?



September 16 1893

Hawaii has such fascinating volcanoes. I will never forget the spectacle of a live volcano by night.

We departed from Hilo to explore Kilauea, a volcano of some 4,000 feet. I took my camera in search of volcanic theatre.

At a full gallop we proceeded generally upwards. Accustomed to riding side-saddle*, I found riding astride a new, if not 'shocking', experience!

Terror filled my every turn. I was pitched and tossed from side to side. I lost my stirrups, lost my seat and then completely lost my horse. Most embarrassing!

The journey up Kilauea was long and tiresome. My guide informed me we would not reach the summit before evening.

Darkness came quickly, leaving us to travel blind under a starless sky. For at least five miles more I languished in my saddle, exhausted by the day's ride and soaked through by the heavy rain.

But then a strange red glow began to light up our path. Heavy fumes filled the air, and I could hear a sound like the roar of a distant ocean.

Finally we stood before it, like sacrifices on the edge of its fiery rim, the craterous molten sea, rising and falling, curling and twisting. Those glorious flames.

* to ride *side-saddle* is to ride with both legs on one side of the horse

4. When Lillian Wild stood on the rim of Kilauea, she was
 - (A) amazed by its magnificence.
 - (B) shocked by the heat of the flames.
 - (C) afraid that she might fall over the edge.
 - (D) feeling relaxed after such a difficult journey.
5. Why is the first section of text placed in a box?
 - (A) so that it looks like an old diary entry
 - (B) because it contains false information
 - (C) to show that it was not written by Lillian Wild
 - (D) to highlight the importance of the information
6. Which of the underlined words in the last paragraph is a preposition?
 - (A) 'we'
 - (B) 'before'
 - (C) 'its'
 - (D) 'and'

Caught red-handed



A priceless piece of art has been stolen from a museum and detectives are called in to investigate the crime. The thieves were very clever – they avoided security cameras, guards and laser beams and their getaway car was never found. However, they left behind one important clue: a single perfect fingerprint. For a top detective, this is more than enough information to solve the crime.

Our fingerprints are very special. You might have the same eye colour as someone else, the same shaped nose and, if you're an identical twin, you might even have a face that looks the same, but not a single person on earth has the same fingerprints as you.

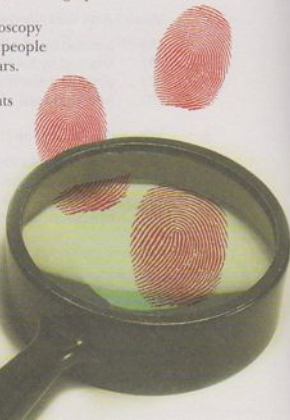
Fingerprints are the patterns on the pads of your fingers made by tiny ridges in the outer layer of your skin, called the epidermis (ep-ee-DER-miss). These ridges help you get a better grip on smooth things. This is particularly important if you're climbing trees and swinging between branches. All primates, including monkeys and apes, have fingerprints.

Most importantly, fingerprints help catch criminals. Dactyloscopy (DACK-till-oss-kop-ae) is the use of fingerprints to identify people and it has been used by police for more than a hundred years.

Every time you touch something you leave sweat and oil prints which are the same pattern as your fingerprints. Criminals often leave very clear fingerprints because the stress of carrying out a crime causes them to sweat more than usual. While these fingerprints are normally invisible, police can make them visible either by dusting them with a fine powder or spraying them with fine chemicals.

Once a fingerprint is developed, it can be compared with images on police files. When comparing fingerprints, police look for particular patterns called arches, loops and whorls.

Many famous crimes have been solved using fingerprints. Unlike people, fingerprints don't lie.



7. Why does the text begin by describing the theft of a piece of art?
- (A) to give an example of a famous crime
 - (B) to emphasise how clever the thieves were
 - (C) to praise the skills of the investigating detective
 - (D) to provide a context for the information which follows
8. A 'priceless piece of art' is one which
- (A) cannot be sold at auction.
 - (B) is too fragile to be displayed.
 - (C) is more beautiful than any other.
 - (D) has a value which cannot be calculated.
9. Part of 'ep-ee-DER-miss' has been written in upper case to show
- (A) it is an abbreviation.
 - (B) an alternative spelling.
 - (C) which part of the word is stressed.
 - (D) the division of the word into syllables.
10. Which of the following are **NOT** used by police to identify a fingerprint pattern?
- (A) loops
 - (B) ridges
 - (C) arches
 - (D) whorls
11. Sequence these events in the order in which they would occur.
1. The fingerprints are dusted.
 2. The fingerprints are located at the scene.
 3. The fingerprints are used to convict the criminals.
 4. The fingerprints are checked against police records.
- (A) 2, 1, 4, 3 (B) 1, 2, 4, 3 (C) 1, 4, 3, 2 (D) 2, 1, 3, 4
12. The writer says 'fingerprints don't lie' in order to emphasise that fingerprints
- (A) provide reliable evidence.
 - (B) have irregular patterns.
 - (C) are always available.
 - (D) can be developed.
13. According to the text, which statement is **INCORRECT**?
- (A) All monkeys have fingerprints.
 - (B) Fingerprints are sometimes invisible.
 - (C) Identical twins have the same fingerprints.
 - (D) Police sometimes spray fingerprints with chemicals.





CARNIVAL OF TERROR

The barker called out his pitch, trying to entice the small crowd inside. Donny found himself drawn to the shabby tent along with a dozen other curious kids. Near the entrance stood faded paintings of the exhibits inside. To Donny they looked kind of silly.

'How much?' he asked the barker.

'To see these living wonders?' the man said, looking him up and down. 'For you, only a dollar.' The man smiled. 'Are you game?'

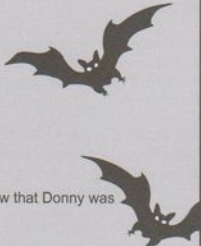
Donny shrugged, paid the creepy-looking man the dollar, and joined the others inside.

But as soon as he saw the 'exhibits' he got very angry. Alligator Man was a man in a green vinyl suit with a papier-mâché alligator head over his own. Rat Woman had fake fur plastered all over her body, huge false buckteeth and silly whiskers. And Magnetron the Magnificent was just a goofy-looking nerd whose hair stood up from static electricity.

'You're all a bunch of fakes!' he yelled.

Storming out of the tent, Donny decided to try the haunted house ride. If that proved to be stupid as well, he would go home. Outside the haunted house stood a deserted cotton candy stand. Donny helped himself, leaving a coin on the counter to ease his conscience.

As he settled into one of the cars that would take him through the haunted house, he decided he would definitely go home after the ride was over. The jerking motion of the car made him a little queasy, and the moth-eaten witches, ghosts and goblins that leaped out at him wouldn't have scared his baby brother. He was getting pretty tired, too, and as if things weren't bad enough, the cotton candy tasted weird. He ate it anyway since it turned out to be the only enjoyable part of the ride.

14. Based on information in the text, a barker is a person who
- (A) works where there is a crowd.
 - (B) advertises aloud to attract people.
 - (C) puts on a show for children to enjoy.
 - (D) shouts at people during an exhibition.
15. By asking Donny, 'Are you game?', the barker was
- (A) quizzing him.
 - (B) criticising him.
 - (C) frightening him.
 - (D) challenging him.
16. Which option shows a point of conflict in the narrative?
- (A) 'How much?'
 - (B) 'To see these living wonders?'
 - (C) 'For you, only a dollar.'
 - (D) 'You're all a bunch of fakes!'
17. The word 'exhibits' is written in quotation marks in the text to show that Donny was
- (A) repeating the advertisement.
 - (B) agreeing with the barker.
 - (C) being sarcastic.
 - (D) saying it loudly.
18. Donny disliked the exhibits in the tent because he thought that they were
- (A) strange. (B) unrealistic. (C) imaginary. (D) embarrassing.
19. From information in the last two paragraphs, what is the best word to describe Donny's mood?
- (A) suspicious (B) helpless (C) frustrated (D) depressed
20. What type of story is suggested by the title *Carnival of Terror*?
- (A) horror (B) fantasy (C) comedy (D) science fiction
- 

For questions 21 and 22 choose the option which is PUNCTUATED CORRECTLY.

21. (A) 'Are Kim's suitcase's packed and ready to go, asked Jack.'
(B) 'Are Kim's suitcases packed and ready to go?' asked Jack.
(C) 'Are Kims suitcases packed and ready to go asked Jack?'
(D) 'Are Kims' suitcases packed, and ready to go?' asked Jack.
22. (A) After the rain stopped, we went outside and Dad found, to his delight, that his car had been washed clean.
(B) After the rain stopped, we went outside and, Dad found, to his delight, that his car had been washed clean.
(C) After the rain stopped we went outside, and Dad found to his delight, that his car had been washed clean.
(D) After the rain stopped, we went outside and Dad found to his delight, that his car had been washed clean.

SHARKS

With their sleek shape and sharp teeth, it is unsurprising that sharks are intimidating predators.

Sharks have what is known as a fusiform body: their bodies are rounded and taper at both the head and tail. This shape reduces drag, so the shark requires less energy to swim. Another reason why sharks can swim at a high speed is the presence of the caudal fin or shark tail which enables the shark to propel its way through water.

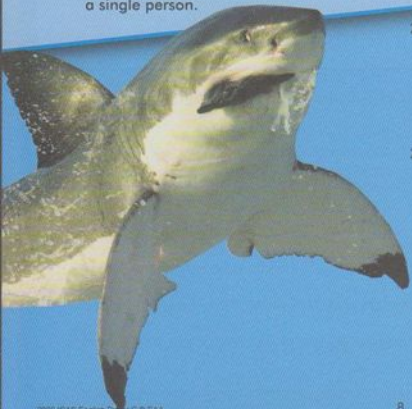
The shape of a shark's caudal fin has evolved according to its needs. For example, the large lower lobe on the porbeagle shark's tail enables it to keep pace with its fast-swimming prey. On the other hand, the thresher's tail has a long and powerful upper lobe which it uses to stun its prey.

Sharks always have sharp teeth because, unlike humans, they have several rows of teeth which continually replace the ones that fall out. Some sharks can lose as many as 30 000 teeth in a lifetime!

Despite their formidable reputation, sharks only kill about one person a year. Shark attacks usually occur when sharks confuse swimmers for prey because their silhouettes look like those of seals.

How, then, can humans protect themselves from shark attacks? Here are some tips from the experts:

- Avoid areas where there are populations of prey.
- Avoid swimming at night when sharks are most active.
- Avoid swimming alone as sharks are more likely to attack a single person.



23. Sharks have a 'fusiform body' so that they can

- (A) swim quickly.
- (B) stun their prey.
- (C) accelerate suddenly.
- (D) twist and turn to hunt.

24. Which of the following tail shapes belongs to the porbeagle shark?

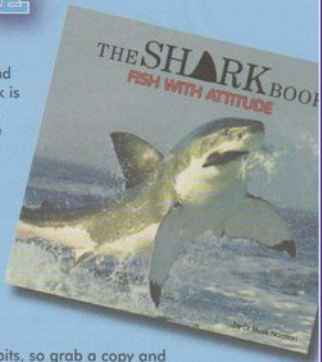
- (A)
- (B)
- (C)
- (D)

THE SHARK BOOK: FISH WITH ATTITUDE

by Dr Mark Norman

Dr Mark Norman is a research scientist at Museum Victoria and has dived with many shark species around the world. His book is chock-a-block with fascinating information about sharks, from the smallest one—the smalleye pygmy, a little thicker than the human thumb—to the whale shark, the biggest fish on Earth. The doctor gives his information in a unique and tantalising way. For instance, when talking about how good a shark's nostrils are for smelling, he says, 'They could sniff a drop of blood in an Olympic-sized swimming pool.' Puts it in perspective, doesn't it? Every page is a learning experience. I now know that most sharks have no eyelids, so they can't close their eyes to go to sleep, and that baby grey nurse sharks eat each other while still inside their mother so only two babies come out alive!

There's no room to tempt you further with more interesting tidbits, so grab a copy and read it for yourself. It would be a good research tool to have in a library.



★★★★ Black Dog Books \$16.99
Reviewed by Merle Morcom Age guide 8+

25. The word 'formidable', as it is used in the text, means
- (A) famous.
 - (B) fearsome.
 - (C) unfavourable.
 - (D) extraordinary.
26. The title *The Shark Book: Fish with Attitude* suggests that sharks are
- (A) popular.
 - (B) powerful.
 - (C) intelligent.
 - (D) aggressive.
27. The sentence 'They could sniff a drop of blood in an Olympic-sized swimming pool' is written in quotation marks because
- (A) it is copied directly from the book.
 - (B) it highlights a common fact about sharks.
 - (C) it draws attention to the uniqueness of sharks.
 - (D) it is something Dr Mark Norman told the reviewer.
28. What do the text *Sharks* and the book *The Shark Book: Fish with Attitude* have in common?
- (A) Both texts explain why sharks attack humans.
 - (B) Both texts advise swimmers about shark safety.
 - (C) Both texts provide interesting facts about sharks.
 - (D) Both texts describe what people usually think about sharks.

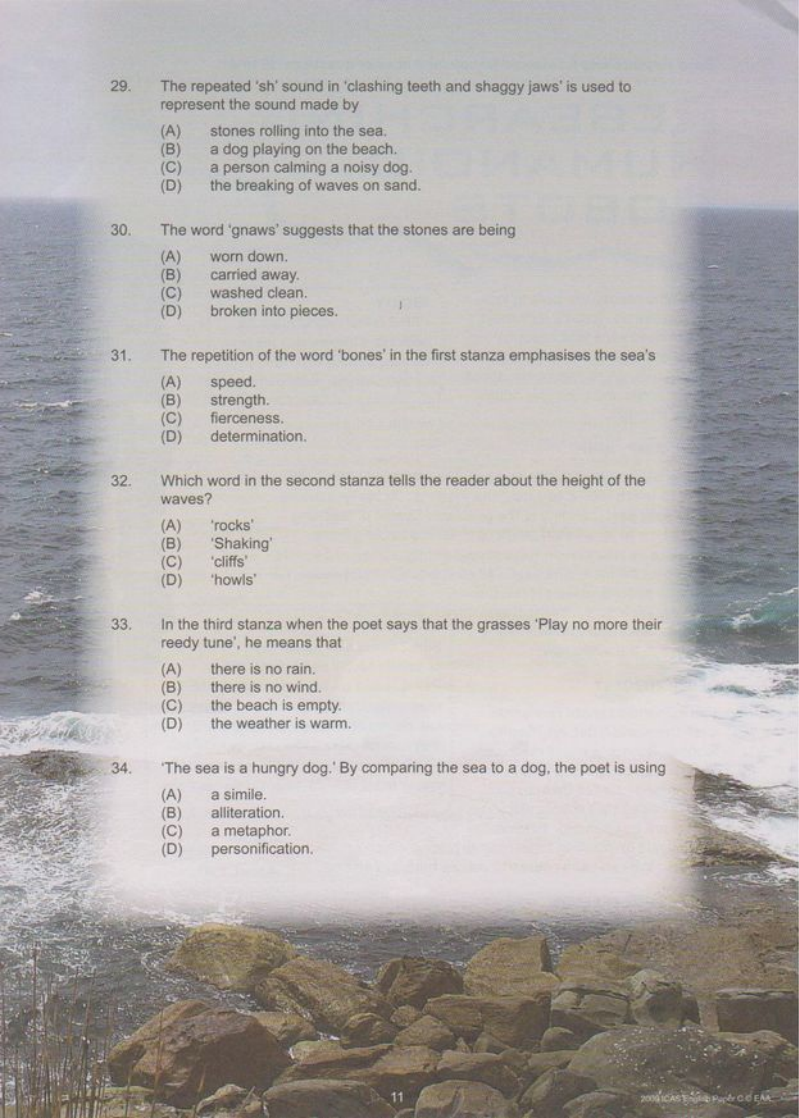
The Sea

The sea is a hungry dog,
Giant and grey.
He rolls on the beach all day.
With his clashing teeth and shaggy jaws
Hour upon hour he gnaws
The rumbling, tumbling stones,
And 'Bones, bones, bones, bones!'
The giant sea-dog moans,
Licking his greasy paws.

And when the night wind roars
And the moon rocks in the stormy cloud,
He bounds to his feet and snuffs and sniffs,
Shaking his wet sides over the cliffs,
And howls and hollos long and loud.

But on quiet days in May or June,
When even the grasses on the dune
Play no more their reedy tune,
With his head between his paws
He lies on the sandy shores,
So quiet, so quiet, he scarcely snores.

James Reeves

- 
29. The repeated 'sh' sound in 'clashing teeth and shaggy jaws' is used to represent the sound made by
- (A) stones rolling into the sea.
 - (B) a dog playing on the beach.
 - (C) a person calming a noisy dog.
 - (D) the breaking of waves on sand.
30. The word 'gnaws' suggests that the stones are being
- (A) worn down.
 - (B) carried away.
 - (C) washed clean.
 - (D) broken into pieces.
31. The repetition of the word 'bones' in the first stanza emphasises the sea's
- (A) speed.
 - (B) strength.
 - (C) fierceness.
 - (D) determination.
32. Which word in the second stanza tells the reader about the height of the waves?
- (A) 'rocks'
 - (B) 'Shaking'
 - (C) 'cliffs'
 - (D) 'howls'
33. In the third stanza when the poet says that the grasses 'Play no more their reedy tune', he means that
- (A) there is no rain.
 - (B) there is no wind.
 - (C) the beach is empty.
 - (D) the weather is warm.
34. 'The sea is a hungry dog.' By comparing the sea to a dog, the poet is using
- (A) a simile.
 - (B) alliteration.
 - (C) a metaphor.
 - (D) personification.

RESEARCHING HUMANOID ROBOTS

Humanoid robots are built to look and act like us. Today's humanoid robots have ears that react to sound and eyes that react to light. They can dance to rap music, shoot soccer goals and even play songs on the trumpet.

JUMP, JUMP, JUMP

Sophie Sakka works with a humanoid robot called HRP-2. 'My job is to teach HRP-2 to jump,' she explains. 'Actually, jumping is the easy part. Landing is the problem.' Sophie is teaching HRP-2 how to land safely, without crashing to the ground. 'HRP-2 uses information from sensors in its ankles and wrists to keep its balance,' she says. 'When it lands, it must react in a split second, or else it will fall over. My job is to study the way humans move and to teach HRP-2 to move in the same way.'

REBEL ROBOTS?

Can humanoid robots really take over the world? 'Not yet,' Sophie laughs. 'Robots are just machines, like cars or computers. They can only do what we tell them to do.' Sophie hopes that robots like HRP-2 will be useful for helping sick people or planting forests or exploring other planets. 'We can send robots to places that we can't go.'

DEGREES OF FREEDOM

Just like you or I can nod our head and wave our hand, robots can move their bodies in different ways. Each type of movement is called a 'degree of freedom' or 'DOF'. HRP-2 has two degrees of freedom in its head: its head can move up and down (one DOF) and side to side (another DOF). In total, HRP-2 has 30 DOF which help it to move smoothly. Maybe that's why robots are such good dancers!

BODY

HRP-2 is learning to move its body like a human. It is the first humanoid robot to be able to get up by itself after falling over.

HANDS

HRP-2 can use its hands to pick things up or to help people carry heavy things. HRP-2 is 154 cm tall and weighs 58 kg. Humanoid robots may look like humans but instead of muscles, skin and blood, they contain metals, motors, sensors and powerful computers. The computers use maths to change movements into numbers.

ANKLES

Movement sensors send information to HRP-2's computer.



- 
35. According to the text, HRP-2 was the first robot ever to
- (A) dance to music.
 - (B) play songs on a trumpet.
 - (C) stand up after falling down.
 - (D) be controlled by a computer.
36. What do the sensors in HRP-2's wrists detect?
- (A) time
 - (B) light
 - (C) sound
 - (D) movement
37. According to Sophie, what is the most important requirement in getting HRP-2 to jump and land safely?
- (A) The robot must land softly so as not to damage its fragile materials.
 - (B) The computer must process data about the robot's height and weight.
 - (C) The robot needs to respond immediately to keep its balance on landing.
 - (D) The computer needs to be told what to do while the robot is still in mid-air.
38. Sophie needs to know about the way humans move so that
- (A) she can make robots easy for people to use.
 - (B) she can design robots that can help sick people.
 - (C) she can create robots which respond to movement.
 - (D) she can program the robots' movements to imitate people.
39. The main purpose of the information in the paragraph titled 'Rebel Robots?' is to
- (A) include humour about robots.
 - (B) present a positive view about robots.
 - (C) encourage people to use more robots.
 - (D) highlight the public's concerns about robots.
40. According to the text, the term 'degree of freedom' refers to HRP-2's
- (A) memory.
 - (B) processing speed.
 - (C) direction of movement.
 - (D) smoothness of actions.
41. A robot receives information (input), processes it and produces an action (output). Which of the following is an output for HRP-2?
- (A) changing movement to numbers
 - (B) adjusting its legs to prevent falling
 - (C) hearing sound with its robotic ears
 - (D) detecting a change in the surroundings

LOST

Panting, I stared through the mass of purple blooms which hung from the curving branches of the trees like crystals on a chandelier. The petals trembled with the cool wind that curled unseen along the riverbank. I felt strangely energetic—nerves, fear, yearning—all in a tangle inside my head.

I stepped down the bank carefully, the pebbles slipping under my bare feet. I knew she was there somewhere. I could hear her faint cries, sounds so very small, as though someone was playing a piano very, very softly so as not to wake anyone up.

The bank was steep, my movement slow. When I reached the river I stood still, my toes under the surface of the cold bubbling water. I stretched them out like the fingers of a hand, pushing them into the chocolatey mud and thick sticky strands of weed, and listened for the tiny bleating. Where was she?

I knew this part of the river well. It was where I would come and read when I wanted to get away from home. Here by the river, my back against a tree, my eyes fixed on black printed words, I could sit peacefully, surrounded by the walls of a natural world that didn't care who I was at all. Ironically, this lack of concern comforted me. Home was not like that. At home I gasped for breath through the smog of concern, raised voices, banging doors, running feet, the screaming kettle, the tumbling, the shouting, the arguments, even the laughter.

Down by the river there was none of that. There was only music—ordered, melancholy music—where each instrument took its part and chimed or plucked or sang, it seemed to me, without conflict or even emotion. Croaking, piping, humming, hooting, rustling, rippling, splashing—if there were any struggles out here by the river, I couldn't tell.

But now as I stood, listening for the little lost creature, I wondered. I heard the ghostly piping of birds, hollow and hard-hearted, the relentless fall of the river over rocks. The wind rose, cooler and stronger. I smelt the scent of the gums as the jacaranda flowers fell into the glassy surface in front of me, like bright feathers of a cruel-beaked exotic parrot. I waited, and I listened.

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42. The narrator was 'panting' at the beginning of the text because she was
- (A) running after an animal.
 - (B) running away from home.
 - (C) anxious about crossing the river.
 - (D) nervous about falling down the bank.

43. Why did the narrator describe stepping into the water in such detail?
- (A) to prove that she was adventurous
(B) to show that she was thinking deeply
(C) to invite the reader to share her experience
(D) to explain why her experience was important
44. The river was a favourite place for the narrator because
- (A) there were few interruptions.
(B) the complete silence was enjoyable.
(C) it was a good place to listen to music.
(D) there were many lost animals nearby.
45. The use of the word 'Ironically' indicates that the narrator wished to
- (A) elaborate on her previous statement.
(B) describe the reasons for her feelings.
(C) give an opinion that the reader might not expect.
(D) emphasise the importance of her next statement.
46. Which of the underlined words in the second last paragraph is an adjective?
- (A) 'only'
(B) 'ordered'
(C) 'without'
(D) 'emotion'
47. This text is an extract from a longer narrative. The purpose of this extract is to
- (A) resolve a situation.
(B) expand a complication.
(C) describe the climax of the plot.
(D) develop characterisation and setting.

For questions 48 to 50 choose the best option to complete the passage.

A Möbius strip is a twisted loop with unusual properties. You can examine its properties (48) a ribbon or strip of paper, make a half twist and tape the ends together. (49) a ribbon or paper, the Möbius strip has only one side. If you draw a line down the middle of the strip until you reach your starting point, you will find that you (50) on both sides of the strip!



- | | | |
|-------------------|--------------------|------------------|
| 48. (A) to use | 49. (A) Either | 50. (A) drew |
| (B) if you use | (B) Unlike | (B) could draw |
| (C) when using | (C) Other than | (C) have drawn |
| (D) first you use | (D) When comparing | (D) were drawing |



E

2009 English Answer Keys

ICAS
International Competitions
and Assessments for Schools

Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
1	A	B	D	B	A	A	A	C
2	A	B	A	D	C	C	C	A
3	B	A	A	C	B	D	B	D
4	C	A	A	B	B	B	A	B
5	A	B	C	C	D	A	D	B
6	A	C	B	A	D	D	D	A
7	C	B	D	B	A	C	A	B
8	C	B	D	A	D	B	C	D
9	C	D	C	A	D	D	A	A
10	B	D	B	A	A	C	A	B
11	D	D	A	B	A	B	C	D
12	D	A	A	C	C	C	C	C
13	D	C	C	C	B	A	A	D
14	B	A	B	D	A	B	B	D
15	C	D	D	D	A	D	D	D
16	D	A	D	A	B	D	D	A
17	A	C	C	C	D	C	B	A
18	B	B	B	D	A	B	B	C
19	C	B	C	C	A	A	B	A
20	A	D	A	D	B	B	D	B
21	D	A	B	B	C	A	C	C
22	B	D	A	C	B	C	B	C
23	C	B	A	B	A	C	D	B
24	B	A	B	D	D	C	B	D
25	A	C	B	C	D	D	A	A
26	C	B	D	B	C	D	C	C
27	C	B	A	A	B	B	C	A
28	A	B	C	C	A	A	D	B
29	D	C	D	B	C	D	A	A
30	B	C	A	C	B	C	B	D
31	B	D	D	A	C	C	D	C
32	C	C	C	D	C	B	C	D
33	A	D	B	B	B	D	D	A
34	D	A	C	D	D	B	A	B
35	B	D	C	D	C	A	A	C
36	A	C	D	A	B	C	B	D
37	A	C	D	A	B	C	B	D
38	B	C	D	A	A	B	D	C
39	D	A	B	C	B	C	A	B
40	D	D	C	D	B	D	C	B

(Please turn over)


E

2009 English Answer Keys

ICAS
 International Competitions
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Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
41	A	D	B	A	C	D	B	B
42	D	D	A	B	D	A	D	D
43	B	C	C	B	D	B	D	A
44	D	A	A	C	C	A	C	B
45	B	C	C	D	C	B	A	A
46			B	B	A	C	C	C
47			D	A	A	A	B	D
48			B	A	B	D	C	A
49			B	A	C	B	A	C
50			C	D	D	A	B	C
51					D	B	A	C
52					D	D	B	A
53					C	A	C	D
54					A	D	A	C
55					B	C	B	D
56							D	D
57							C	B
58							B	D
59							D	C
60							D	A

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